

Spiritual Gems — July 20-26, 2026

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Bible reading: Jeremiah 18-19 *“What spiritual gems from this week’s Bible reading would you like to share?”*

15 options + 2 research/insight angles (highlighted in blue in the HTML/PDF). Each ~20-30 sec spoken (about 55-75 words). Avoids the Treasures verses (Jer 18:7, 8, 11, 12) and the official Insight question (Jer 18:6; 19:10, 11).

#	Verse	What I take away
1	Jer 18:2	Jehovah can teach us by sending us to ordinary places
2	Jer 18:3	Jeremiah obeyed before he understood the lesson
3	Jer 18:4	Spoiled clay was not thrown away immediately
4	Jer 18:10	Blessings are connected to listening, not spiritual history
5	Jer 18:13	Jehovah invites people to compare and think
6	Jer 18:14	Creation can be more dependable than God's own people
7	Jer 18:15	Forgetting Jehovah usually starts with small side paths
8	Jer 18:17	Jehovah's face is something we never want to lose
9	Jer 18:18	Opposition often disguises itself as confidence
10	Jer 18:19	Jeremiah took opposition to Jehovah first
11	Jer 18:20	Real ministers speak good even for difficult people
12	Jer 18:23	Jehovah knows schemes we may not be able to prove
13	Jer 19:1, 2	Jeremiah had to carry the message into an uncomfortable place
14	Jer 19:4	False worship can make a place unrecognizable
15	Jer 19:5	Jehovah rejects cruelty completely
R1	Jer 18:1-4	 <i>Insight book:</i> Jeremiah used a living illustration, not just words
R2	Jer 19:1, 10, 11	 <i>Insight book:</i> the broken flask made the warning unforgettable

1 • Jeremiah 18:2

Potter's house

What I like about Jer 18:2 is that Jehovah did not teach Jeremiah only by giving him information. He sent him to a workshop. An ordinary place became a classroom. That tells me Jehovah knows how to teach in ways that reach the heart. In the ministry, I can help people notice lessons from daily life, not just give them

facts.

2 • Jeremiah 18:3

He went down

Jer 18:3 shows Jeremiah's obedience. Jehovah told him to go to the potter's house, and Jeremiah went. At that point, he did not yet know the full lesson. That is a useful pattern for me. Sometimes Jehovah's direction becomes clearer after I obey, not before. Faith does not always wait until every detail is explained.

3 • Jeremiah 18:4

Reworked into another vessel

Jer 18:4 is comforting because the clay became spoiled, but the potter did not immediately discard it. He reworked it. That helps me see Jehovah as patient and skilled. When a person is willing to be shaped, a mistake does not have to be the end of the story. Jehovah can still make something useful and beautiful.

4 • Jeremiah 18:10

Does not obey

Jer 18:10 reminds me that past blessings do not remove the need for present obedience. Jehovah may intend good for a person or a people, but if they stop listening, they can lose what he wanted to give them. That is sobering. My relationship with Jehovah is not maintained by yesterday's faithfulness. I need to keep listening today.

5 • Jeremiah 18:13

Ask among the nations

In Jer 18:13, Jehovah says, in effect, “Ask around.” He invites comparison. That tells me Jehovah is not afraid of honest thinking. His people had done something shocking, and he wanted them to see how unreasonable their course was. In the ministry, we can do something similar by asking thoughtful questions that help people examine where a course is leading.

6 • Jeremiah 18:14

Snow of Lebanon

Jer 18:14 uses a natural picture: the snow of Lebanon and cold flowing waters. Those things were dependable. But Jehovah’s people had become less dependable than creation itself. That makes me think about loyalty. The natural world quietly obeys Jehovah’s design. I want my own worship to be just as steady, not something that dries up when pressure comes.

7 • Jeremiah 18:15

Ancient paths

Jer 18:15 says God’s people left the ancient paths and walked on side roads. That is often how spiritual danger starts. Not with a dramatic rejection of Jehovah, but with little alternative paths that feel harmless. This verse helps me ask: Am I staying on the path Jehovah has marked out, or am I getting comfortable with spiritual shortcuts?

8 • Jeremiah 18:17

My back, not my face

Jer 18:17 is painful. Jehovah says he would show his back, not his face, in the day of disaster. The worst part of judgment was not just the trouble itself. It was losing Jehovah's favorable attention. That teaches me what repentance protects. When I respond to counsel early, I am really protecting the privilege of having Jehovah's face toward me.

9 • Jeremiah 18:18

Against Jeremiah

Jer 18:18 shows the confidence of Jeremiah's opposers. They assumed they still had priests, wise men, and prophets, so they did not need to listen to Jeremiah. It is a warning. Religious structure can make people feel secure even when they are resisting Jehovah. I never want confidence in arrangements to become a substitute for humility before Jehovah's word.

10 • Jeremiah 18:19

Pay attention to me

What moves me in Jer 18:19 is that Jeremiah did not start by fighting his opponents directly. He turned to Jehovah: "Pay attention to me." That is a good pattern when we feel misunderstood or attacked. Before we defend ourselves, we can pour the matter out to Jehovah. He hears the whole conversation, including the parts no one else knows.

11 • Jeremiah 18:20

Speak good about them

Jer 18:20 shows Jeremiah's conscience. The people were digging a pit for him, but he could say that he had stood before Jehovah to speak good about them. That is real shepherding spirit. In the ministry, and in the congregation, I want to be able to say the same: even when people are difficult, I tried to speak for their good.

12 • Jeremiah 18:23

You know

Jer 18:23 contains a short but strengthening thought: Jehovah knew all their schemes. Jeremiah did not have to prove every motive or expose every plot by himself. Jehovah already knew. That can calm us when something is unfair. We do not need to carry the burden of seeing everything. Jehovah sees, remembers, and acts at the right time.

13 • Jeremiah 19:1, 2

Valley of the Son of Hinnom

Jer 19:1, 2 shows that Jeremiah had to carry Jehovah's message to a very uncomfortable place, the Valley of the Son of Hinnom. That was not a pleasant setting for a spiritual message. But Jehovah chose it because the location itself exposed the seriousness of Judah's sin. It reminds me that courage sometimes means speaking the truth where the setting is hard.

14 • Jeremiah 19:4

Made this place unrecognizable

Jer 19:4 says the people had made that place unrecognizable. That phrase struck me. False worship did not just add a few bad practices; it changed the character of the place. Sin can do that to a person too. It can make someone almost unrecognizable spiritually. But the warning itself shows Jehovah still wanted people to wake up.

15 • Jeremiah 19:5

Never came up in my heart

Jer 19:5 reveals something beautiful about Jehovah. The people were committing horrible acts in worship of Baal, but Jehovah says such cruelty had never come up in his heart. That tells me he is completely separate from the violence and abuse often connected with false religion. In the ministry, that is worth sharing. Jehovah is not cruel. He is clean.



R1 • Jeremiah 18:1-4 — *Insight book connection*

The potter's house

The *Insight* material on Jeremiah notes that Jehovah had Jeremiah use dramatic illustrations. The visit to the potter was one of them. That teaches me something about Jehovah as a teacher. He did not give Jeremiah an abstract lecture. He gave him a scene he could watch, remember, and retell. Good teaching often helps people see the point, not just hear it.



The broken flask

The *Insight* material also mentions Jeremiah breaking a flask before the older men as a symbol of what would happen to Jerusalem. That must have been unforgettable: the sound, the fragments, the finality. Jehovah's warning was not vague. He made the danger visible. It reminds me that Bible illustrations are not decoration. They can make Jehovah's message land in the conscience.